

SPEAKING UP

Talking Points: What to Say and Where to Say It

Ready-to-use language for city council meetings, conversations with neighbors, and local media interviews.

CORE MESSAGE

The Message That Works

ICE is using corrupt real estate deals to build concentration camps in American communities — in secret, without telling local officials, and without any plan for the impact on our infrastructure, our safety, or our families. Communities across the country are fighting back and winning. We can too.

This message works because it:

- **Leads with corruption** — the secrecy and no-bid contracts are universally offensive, not partisan
- **Centers your community** — it's about what's happening here, not abstract immigration policy
- **Names a win** — other communities have already succeeded, which makes your fight feel winnable

AT CITY COUNCIL

Speaking at Public Hearings

Most city councils allow 2-3 minutes of public comment. Here's how to use them:

Opening (15 seconds):

"My name is [NAME], I live at [STREET/NEIGHBORHOOD], and I'm here because a federal contractor is trying to build a detention facility in our community without telling any of you."

Infrastructure argument (60 seconds):

"This warehouse was built for 50 to 100 daytime workers. The plan is to house 1,500 or more people there 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. Our sewage system, our water supply, our roads, and our

emergency services were never designed for this. In Schuylkill County, Pennsylvania, the proposed facility would hold 7,500 people — but the local sewage system was built to serve 2,400. This isn't an immigration question. It's an infrastructure crisis."

Corruption argument (45 seconds):

"These deals are happening in secret. No-bid contracts worth hundreds of millions of dollars. No environmental review. No public input. In Berks County, Pennsylvania, the contract is \$158 million. In Schuylkill County, it's \$119.5 million. Who's getting rich, and why wasn't our community consulted?"

The ask (15 seconds):

"I'm asking this council to pass a moratorium on detention facilities in our jurisdiction, just like communities in Missouri, Virginia, and Maryland have already done. Other communities stopped this. We can too."

PRO TIP: Bring Neighbors

The single most effective thing you can do at a city council meeting is show up with 20 people. Numbers speak louder than any individual comment. Coordinate with neighbors to attend together even if only a few speak.

WITH NEIGHBORS

Conversations That Work

Not everyone in your community will agree on immigration policy. That's okay. Here's how to talk to people across the spectrum:

With concerned neighbors who are unsure:

"I get that people have different views on immigration. But this isn't about that — this is about whether a warehouse in our neighborhood should be turned into a facility housing thousands of people without anyone asking us. The sewage system alone can't handle it. And nobody told our city council."

With conservative neighbors:

"Even Republican officials are fighting these facilities. In Arizona, a Republican Party district chair was censured for opposing the warehouse in Surprise — but she's still fighting. In New Jersey, a Republican township council unanimously opposed the facility. This is about local control and property values, not party politics."

With skeptical neighbors:

"Look at what happened inside ICE facilities in Texas — measles outbreaks, contaminated water, documented deaths. And those were purpose-built facilities. These warehouses have none of that infrastructure. Do we want that in our neighborhood?"

WITH MEDIA

Talking to Local Reporters

Local media is your most powerful amplifier. Here are key messages for interviews:

The lead:

"A federal contractor is secretly negotiating to turn [LOCATION] into a detention facility that could hold [NUMBER] people. Our community wasn't told. Our city council wasn't consulted. We found out on our own, and we're fighting back."

The stakes:

"This is a [dollar amount] contract paid for with our tax dollars. The facility would overwhelm our [sewage/water/roads]. And based on documented conditions in existing ICE facilities — measles outbreaks, contaminated water, deaths in custody — it would create a public health risk for everyone who lives nearby."

The hope:

"Five communities across America have already stopped these facilities. Minnesota, Missouri, Utah, Virginia, and others are organizing right now. We know this can be won because other people have already won it."

Three rules for media interviews: (1) Always lead with your community, not national politics. (2) Use specific numbers — dollar amounts, population capacity, sewage capacity. (3) Always name the wins. People need to believe this fight is winnable.